Calling parse! triggers a walk through the ARGV array, calling the blocks of any options that it encounters and destructively removing those options and their arguments from ARGV. Removing the options allows you to easily have a command line that mixes options and non-options, so you can do something like my_code.rb -x --database postgres other_file other_thing, then the parse! removes the option switches, and you end up with ARGV equals ["other_file", "other_thing"].

You can also specify a keyword argument, into:, which takes an existing object (usually a hash) and causes all the parsed options to be placed into that argument. The key is the option itself, the value is either the return value of the block, the argument value if there is no block, or true if there is neither a block nor an argument:

rubyworld/option_3.rb

```
require "optparse"

parser = OptionParser.new

parser.on("-x") do
  puts "yep, do the x thing"
  true
end

parser.on("-yTYPE", "--y") do |value|
  puts "There's a y with #{value}"
  value
end

options = {}
parser.parse!(into: options)

p ARGV
p options
```

If you want a more powerful framework for building CLI interfaces, you should check out Thor,[1] which uses a different API to attach subcommands and options to different parts of your code.

Program Termination

The method exit terminates your program, returning a status value to the operating system. However, unlike some languages, exit doesn't terminate the program immediately—exit first raises a SystemExit exception, which you may catch, and then performs a number of cleanup actions, including running any registered at_exit methods and object finalizers.

Accessing Environment Variables

You can access operating system environment variables using the predefined variable ENV. It responds to the same methods as Hash. Technically, ENV is not actually a hash—it's a separate class—but if you need to, you can convert it into a Hash using ENV#to_h.

```
ENV['SHELL']
ENV['HOME']
ENV['USER']
ENV.keys.size
ENV.keys[0, 4]
```

1. http://whatisthor.com